> *system; that by good government we may educate our subjects into a capacity for better government; that, having become instructed in European knowledge, they may, in some future age, demand European institutions. Whether such a day will ever come I know not. But never will I attempt to avert or to retard it. Whenever it comes, it will be the proudest day in English history. To have found a great people sunk in the lowest depths of slavery and superstition, to have so ruled them as to have made them desirous and capable of all the privileges of citizens, would indeed be a title to glory all our own. The sceptre may pass away from us. Unforeseen accidents may derange our most profound schemes of policy. Victory may be inconstant to our arms. But there are triumphs which are followed by no reverse. There is an empire exempt from all natural causes of decay. Those triumphs are the pacific triumphs of reason over barbarism; that empire is the imperishable empire of our arts and our morals, our literature and our laws* [emphasis added].

Macaulay's speech captures the essence of colonial consciousness so thoroughly that I do not think I can improve upon it. On 19 July 1833,[38] the ramping up of Church infrastructure in India was discussed in the House of Commons, with significant support for the proposal of Charles Grant, reflected in the debates as follows:

> Mr. Finch—supported the clause, and contended, *that it was necessary for the advancement of religion that there should be an Established Church in India able to meet the increasing Christian population.*
>
> Mr. O'Dwyer—opposed the clause, and said, that he could see no necessity for increasing the Episcopal Establishment in India. It would be moreover a precedent to extend the Church Establishment all over the British territory.
>
> Mr. Ruthven—opposed the clause, at some length, and said, that it would be more fair if all denominations were placed on the same footing. He objected strongly to introducing a Church Establishment into India when this country was groaning under the weight of a Church Establishment.
>
> Lord Morpeth—*When he compared the amount of service to be performed, and the extent of country and population over which it was*